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‘It was almost indescribable. It was unlike anything we’ve hosted.’

TRAVIS POLLIO, *director of Red Sox ticket strategy, speaking of the Tartan Army at Fenway Park*



JESSICA RINALDI/GLOBE STAFF

PLAID TIDINGS: SCOTS BRING PARTY TO BOSTON

A joyful, boisterous Tartan Army shows the city the ways of the World Cup



JOHN TLUMACKI/BOSTON GLOBE

Top: Bagpipers led the Tartan Army to Fenway Park for Scottish Celebration Night. Above: Luke Allan from Inverness, Scotland, tried out the slide at City Hall.

By Brian MacQuarrie
GLOBE STAFF

Since they swaggered into town last week for the World Cup, they seem to be everywhere: kilt-clad throngs singing, chanting, and marching to the skirl of bagpipes. They even raised the roof at Fenway Park, no easy feat these days.

They are the very thirsty soldiers of Scotland’s Tartan Army, as the national team’s fans are known, here to cheer on their beloved players. And they are just the release valve that Boston needed to shake off any lingering doubts that the region could pull it off.

They’ve become the area’s honorary mascots for the World Cup, and they’ve brought more visitors to Boston for a single event than any country ever has, said Dave O’Donnell, vice president of Meet Boston, which promotes the city.

“We knew that we had struck gold when we learned back in December that the Tartan Army would be coming here, but I don’t think that anyone could’ve predicted the actual impact, which has been immense and electrify-

SCOTS, Page A7

Poll shows support for Healey, even if voters aren’t clear on what she’s done

By Samantha J. Gross
GLOBE STAFF

More than half of Massachusetts voters said they can’t point to a signature accomplishment Governor Maura Healey has made during her first term. Yet, the Democrat still appears poised to win reelection easily, a new Suffolk University/Boston Globe poll found.

About 56 percent of the 500 voters surveyed said that if the general election were today, they would vote for, or lean toward, Healey over either of her potential Republican opponents,

with the incumbent holding leads of 25 and 27 percentage points over Mike Minogue or Brian Shortleeve, respectively, according to the poll.

The dynamic underscores a race where Healey’s greatest achievement is not a lone standout policy initiative or political win, but “simply [her] not being the other guy,” said David Paleologos, director of the Suffolk University Political Research Center.

“A 25-point lead without a signature achievement . . . it’s not a referendum on her past, it’s a verdict on the opponents’ future,” said Paleolo-

gos. In other words, he said: Being a Democratic incumbent in deep-blue Massachusetts, with an unpopular Republican president in the White House, means Healey can likely override any policy deficiency.

The poll found that voters feel less confident that the state is headed in the right direction than in the year Healey was elected governor. Voters also said they would overwhelmingly opt for US Senator Ed Markey or US Representative Seth Moulton for US Senate over the de facto Republican

POLL, Page A6

Amid inflation, Warsh offers no rate cut — and no hints

New Fed chief does away with ‘forward guidance’ on plans

By Jim Puzzanghera
GLOBE STAFF

WASHINGTON — In his first news conference as Federal Reserve chair on Wednesday, Kevin Warsh showed he’s a man of few words.

Unfortunately for President Trump, who appointed Warsh in hopes of getting significantly lower interest rates, none of those words were “rate cut.”

In fact, about half of the members on the Fed’s rate-setting committee indicated the Central Bank’s next move might be an *increase* in rates by the end of the year to try to squelch rapidly rising inflation.

So, despite a change atop the independent central bank, the seat remains hot as Warsh juggles Trump’s demands for low-

er rates with a US economy under strain from tariffs and the Iran war.

After a two-day meeting, Fed officials unanimously voted to hold their benchmark interest rate steady at a range between 3.5 and 3.75 percent as analysts had expected. The rate setting committee chaired by Warsh made the announcement in a terse written statement that was just 132 words — less than half of the 344-word statement issued in April after outgoing chair Jerome Powell’s last meeting.

Moreover, Warsh’s first post-meeting news conference was about 42 minutes long, down from the typical 50 to 60 minutes under Powell. The close-to-the vest style — eschewing any formal hints of future actions known as “forward guidance” — harkened back to the 1990s under legendary Fed Chair Alan Greenspan instead of the more open approach that began during the 2008 financial crisis.

WARSH, Page A7



CHIP SOMODEVILLA/GETTY IMAGES

Federal Reserve Chair Kevin Warsh spoke with reporters on Wednesday. His news conference was shorter than those under Jerome Powell.

New tests weighed for high schoolers

Mass. also recommends capstone project for grads

By Marcela Rodrigues
GLOBE STAFF

Less than two years after Massachusetts voters scrapped a standardized test as a graduation requirement for high school, state officials want to introduce new tests in core subjects that could influence whether students will earn a diploma.

The new tests were among the final recommendations issued Wednesday as part of a broader effort to reshape high school graduation requirements in Massachusetts. The overhaul would also require students to demonstrate financial literacy, learn how to use artificial intelligence, complete a capstone project, and more.

Officials hope that, starting with the high school class of 2032, students will once again have to take exams, and satisfy additional requirements, to earn a diploma.

But the role of the new tests in satisfying graduation requirements is unclear. On the one hand, officials said students will not be required to pass the new tests for graduation; on the other hand, the recommendations say the exams will “meaningfully count toward students’ academic record.”

How “meaningfully” is not yet known. State officials have yet to define the term.

“The exam is part of the course; it is not the sole determinant to stop a student from graduating,” said Alana Davidson, deputy chief of staff at the

REQUIREMENTS, Page A6

State installing wrong-way driver cameras

Addition of warning lights follows trooper’s death

By Lea Skene
GLOBE STAFF

After a Massachusetts State Police trooper was killed when a wrong-way driver plowed into his cruiser on Route 1 in Lynnfield last month, state officials on Wednesday announced a series of new measures designed to prevent similar accidents.

They include installing more than 400 thermal detection camera systems to identify wrong-way drivers and immediately trigger red warning lights illuminating WRONG WAY signs. That will hopefully prompt drivers to turn around, especially at night when existing signs could otherwise be harder to see. The systems will also alert law enforcement in real time.

“We sadly cannot change the past, but we can do what is necessary to ensure that tragedies like this don’t happen again,” Governor Maura Healey said during a news conference Wednesday morning at the State Police barracks in Danvers.

The location was significant because it’s where Trooper Kevin Trainor reported for duty — until his career was cut short during a routine commute home in the early morning hours of May 6. Trainor,

WRONG-WAY DRIVERS, Page A6

President Trump issued a fiery defense of his deal with Iran, lashing out at critics who said it achieves even less than the one President Obama negotiated and threatening to bomb Iran again if it doesn’t adhere to the agreement. **A3.**

Mayor Michelle Wu reversed a move by the City Council to cut the transportation department’s staff budget in a bid to avoid potential layoffs. **B1.**

Thousands of nurses at Brigham and Women’s Hospital authorized a one-day strike as union contract negotiations stalled. **D1.**



Shower power

Thursday: Rain, storm later. High: 73-78. Low: 64-69.

Friday: Breezy, warmer. High: 82-87. Low: 63-68.

Sunrise: 5:07 Sunset: 8:24 Comics and Weather, **D5-6.**

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